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Study Courses

Non-EU students can apply for a long-stay visa for studies (marked D/SD) if they are enrolled in the following types of programs:

- Pre-university education programs.
- Undergraduate (Bachelor's degree) programs.
- Post-graduate (Master's or Doctorate) programs.
- Romanian language preparatory year (required for those studying in Romanian who do not have a certificate of proficiency).
- Student exchange programs or educational projects.

Embassy Appointment

To book an appointment for a study visa, students must use the official electronic portal of the Romanian Ministry of Foreign Affairs:

- Visit the E-VISA portal at evisa.mae.ro.
- Create an account and fill out the online application.
- Upload digital copies of the required documents.
- Once the application is validated online, the system will allow the user to choose an available date and time for an in-person interview at the nearest Romanian diplomatic mission or consular office.

Applying for a Study Visa

How to apply

- The student must first receive a letter of acceptance from the Romanian Ministry of Education.
- Register and submit the application via the E-VISA online portal.
- Attend the scheduled appointment at the embassy to submit original documents and provide biometric data.

How long it usually takes

- Visa processing typically takes between 30 and 60 days. It is recommended to apply at least two months before the intended travel date.

What documents are needed

- Detailed in Section 4.

Documents Needed

Before applying, students must prepare the following:

- Valid travel document (passport) recognized by Romania, valid for at least three months after the intended visa expiration.
- Official letter of acceptance for studies issued by the Romanian Ministry of Education.
- Proof of payment of the tuition fee for at least one academic year.
- Proof of financial means (see Section 5).
- Criminal record certificate or another document with the same legal value, issued by the authorities in the country of origin.
- Medical insurance covering the entire period of the visa validity, with a minimum coverage of 30,000 EUR.
- Parental or guardian consent for the stay in Romania for study purposes (if the student is under 18).
- Proof of accommodation (e.g., dormitory contract, lease agreement, or notarized statement from a host).

Money Requirements

- Students must prove they have the financial means to support themselves during their stay.
- The requirement is to prove an amount at least equal to the minimum gross basic salary per month for the entire period requested on the visa.
- **As of 2024, the minimum gross basic salary is 3,300 RON per month (approximately 660 EUR).**
- **Correct information:** This figure is outdated. The 3,300 RON level only applied from October 2023 to June 2024. Since 1 July 2024 it was 3,700 RON, and since 1 January 2025 the minimum gross basic salary has been 4,050 RON per month (about 770 EUR). From 1 July 2026 it rises to 4,325 RON per month (about 825 EUR), under Government Decision (HG) no. 146/2026. (Source: Monitorul Oficial al României / Guvernul României, HG nr. 146/2026)
- Evidence is usually provided through bank statements from a personal account.

Residence Permit

Once in Romania, the student must obtain a residence permit (Single Permit) from the General Inspectorate for Immigration (IGI):

- Applications must be submitted at least 30 days before the right of stay granted by the visa expires.
- Students must visit the local IGI office in the county where they reside.
- The permit is usually issued for one year, or for the duration of the studies if less than one year.

Working While Studying

Non-EU students holding a valid study residence permit are allowed to work in Romania under the following conditions:

- They can work for a maximum of 4 hours per day without needing a separate work authorization.
- The work must be based on an individual part-time labor contract.
- Exceeding 4 hours per day requires a full work permit, which involves a different application process by the employer.

Renewing the Residence Permit

If the study program lasts longer than one year, the residence permit must be renewed annually:

- Submit the application to the General Inspectorate for Immigration (IGI) at least 30 days before the current permit expires.
- Required documents include a certificate from the university confirming the student is enrolled in the next year of study, proof of continued financial means, and proof of health insurance.

Changing to a Work Permit

After graduating from a higher education program in Romania, students can change their status to a work permit:

- The graduate must find an employer willing to hire them.
- The student can apply to extend their right of stay for "job searching or business startup" for a period of up to 9 months post-graduation.
- Once a job is secured, the employer must apply for a work authorization at the IGI.
- After the work authorization is issued, the student applies for a change in the purpose of their residence permit from "studies" to "work."

Official Information

Official legal information and updates can be found on the following websites:

- Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MAE): mae.ro
- General Inspectorate for Immigration (IGI): igi.mai.gov.ro
- Ministry of Education: edu.ro
- E-VISA Portal: evisa.mae.ro

Application Forms

Forms can be accessed and downloaded via:

- The E-VISA portal (online forms): evisa.mae.ro
- The General Inspectorate for Immigration website (for residence permit forms): igi.mai.gov.ro/en/category/forms/
- **Correct information:** This page only lists general administrative forms (petitions, audience requests, public-information requests) – it does not contain a downloadable application form for the student residence permit. The IGI does not publish that specific form online; the application is submitted in person at the local IGI office (which provides the form there) or through the online portal portaligi.mai.gov.ro. (Source: General Inspectorate for Immigration, igi.mai.gov.ro)

Tips for Students

To avoid delays or rejections, students should avoid these common mistakes:

- Submitting an application with a passport that expires too soon; ensure the passport is valid for at least six months beyond the visa date.
- **Correct information:** This contradicts the requirement stated earlier in this document (Section 4) and the official rule. According to the Romanian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, the passport must be valid for at least three months after the intended date of departure from Romania – not six months. (Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Romania, mae.ro)
- Providing bank statements that do not clearly show the student's name or the required monthly minimum amount.
- Failing to translate documents into Romanian; all official documents (criminal records, diplomas) must be translated by a certified translator and legalized or apostilled.
- Missing the 30-day deadline for the residence permit application after arrival, which can lead to fines or the obligation to leave the country.
- Applying for the visa without the official Acceptance Letter from the Ministry of Education; a simple letter from the university is not sufficient for the visa process.

1. Study Courses That Qualify for a Study Visa

A non-EU national can apply for a Romanian long-stay visa for studies (type D/SD) for:

- Bachelor's degree programs
- Master's degree programs
- **PhD and postdoctoral studies**
- **Correct information:** The IGI's studies page lists this category as "student, master student or PhD student" only – it does not include postdoctoral researchers. Postdoctoral research is normally carried out under a separate long-stay visa for "scientific research activities" (governed by Government Decision/Order of the Ministry of Research, Innovation and Digitalization, not the Ministry of Education's study-acceptance letter). (Source: General Inspectorate for Immigration, igi.mai.gov.ro/en/studies/; Ministry of Research, Innovation and Digitalization, mcid.gov.ro)
- Student exchange programs (ages 13–19)
- Pre-university education (high school cycle), for students of Romanian origin, state scholarship holders, or those exempt from tuition fees
- Unpaid vocational training/internship programs (as a trainee)
- A preparatory year of Romanian language, for those who don't yet meet the language requirement

In all cases, the institution (public or private) must be accredited or provisionally authorized by Romanian law, and the program must be full-time.

Correct information: This applies to the higher-education, exchange-program, and pre-university categories above, but not to the unpaid vocational training/internship category. For trainees, the official requirement is a training agreement with a host entity (plus a written commitment from that entity), not institutional accreditation. (Source: General Inspectorate for Immigration, igi.mai.gov.ro/en/studies/)

2. Booking an Embassy/Consulate Appointment

All Romanian visa applications, including for studies, are processed through the e-Viza online portal: <https://evisa.mae.ro>

Steps:

- Create an account on the e-Viza portal
- Complete the online D/SD visa application form
- Upload the required supporting documents
- Once the file is marked "Valid," book an appointment ("Programare") at the chosen Romanian embassy or consulate for the in-person submission of original documents
- There is no other way to schedule an appointment; the portal is the only official booking channel

Find the list of Romanian diplomatic missions abroad here: <https://www.mae.ro> (under "Romanian missions abroad")

Note: As of May 2026, short-stay (Schengen) visa applications can also be submitted through additional channels, according to the MAE. For study (D/SD) visas specifically, the e-Viza portal remains the standard route – check your nearest embassy’s website for any local variations.

3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa in Romania

Documents Needed

See Section 4 below for the full list (varies slightly by study level).

How to Apply

- Apply to a Romanian university and receive an offer/admission letter
- Get your Letter of Acceptance issued by the Romanian Ministry of Education (the university forwards your file there – this step is mandatory and is separate from the university’s own offer letter)
- Pay at least one year’s tuition fee (unless exempted, e.g. as a state scholarship holder)
- Register and apply online via <https://evisa.mae.ro>
- Upload supporting documents and wait for the file to be validated
- Book and attend an appointment at the relevant Romanian embassy/consulate to submit original documents, biometric data, and pay the visa fee
- Wait for the decision

How Long It Takes

- The legal maximum for a decision is 60 days, though this includes the internal step where the IGI gives a “favorable opinion” (issued within 30 days, extendable by 15 days)
- The Ministry recommends submitting your application at least 45 days before your intended travel date, but no earlier than 3 months before your trip
- The D/SD visa, once granted, is valid for 90 days with one or more entries – it is meant to let you enter Romania and then apply for a residence permit once there, not to cover your whole study period

4. Documents Needed

Required documents differ slightly by category. For higher education students (bachelor’s, master’s, PhD):

- Online visa application form (completed via e-Viza)
- Valid passport (original and copy)
- Recent passport-style photo(s)
- Letter of acceptance for studies, issued by the Romanian Ministry of Education
- Proof of payment of tuition fees for at least one academic year
- Proof of sufficient financial means (see Section 5)
- Criminal record certificate (or equivalent legal document) from your home country
- Medical/travel insurance valid for the period of the visa
- Parental/guardian consent, if the applicant is a minor

- Proof of knowledge of the language of instruction (not required for those taking the Romanian-language preparatory year)

For student exchange participants, Romanian-origin scholarship pupils, and trainees, the document list differs – see the IGI’s official studies page for the exact lists:

<https://igi.mai.gov.ro/en/studies/>

5. Money Requirements (Proof of Financial Means)

- A student must show funds equal to at least the minimum gross national salary guaranteed in Romania, for each month of the period stated on the visa
- This applies both at the visa stage and again later, when applying for/renewing the residence permit (where proof must cover at least 6 months at a time)
- Exemptions: Romanian state scholarship holders, scholarship holders at accredited public universities, and applicants of Romanian origin are not required to prove means of support
- Because the minimum gross salary is updated periodically by the Romanian government, check the current figure before applying. The IGI and MAE pages do not display a fixed EUR amount; it is tied to the legally set Romanian minimum wage at the time of application.

6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival

- You must apply for a residence permit within the 90 days covered by your entry visa, and at least 30 days before that right of stay expires
- Submit the application to the territorial unit of the General Inspectorate for Immigration (IGI) in the county where you will live, either in person or through the online portal: <https://portaligi.mai.gov.ro/portaligi/>

Required documents for higher-education students (first extension):

- Application form (downloadable from IGI’s site)
- Travel document (original and copy)
- Letter of acceptance for studies (only needed for the first extension)
- Certificate from the educational institution confirming full-time enrollment
- Proof of means of support (at least 6 months’ worth)
- Proof of legal right to the accommodation/living space (original and copy)
- Medical certificate
- Payment of the applicable fee

Processing: the IGI must resolve the application within 30 days of submission (extendable by up to 15 days if further checks are needed)

7. Working While Studying

- Students holding a temporary residence permit for studies can work without needing a separate work permit, as long as it is part-time, under an individual employment contract
- According to the IGI’s current official guidance (igi.mai.gov.ro), the limit is up to 6 hours per day

- Some third-party legal/relocation sites still cite an older limit of 4 hours per day (20 hours/week) – this appears to reflect a previous rule. Given the discrepancy between sources, it's worth confirming the current limit directly with the IGI or your local Immigration Bureau before starting work
- Working more hours, or full-time, requires a separate work permit/authorization from the employer's side

8. Renewing the Residence Permit for Courses Longer Than One Year

- The residence permit must be renewed at least 30 days before it expires
- For students and pupils, the right of residence can be extended for a period equal to the total duration of the study program (so multi-year programs are covered by successive renewals, not a single long-dated permit)
- For exchange program participants, extensions are capped at one year at a time
- If a student does not finish their studies within the originally granted period, a further extension to complete studies can be granted, not exceeding one additional year
- Renewal documents are largely the same as for the first application, except the Ministry of Education letter of acceptance is not required again after the first extension

9. Changing a Study Permit into a Work Permit After Graduation

- After graduation, the right of temporary residence for study purposes can be extended for up to 9 months to allow for job-seeking, taking up employment, or starting a business – the student must submit documents proving completion of studies
- Separately, the permit may be extended for up to 6 months after graduation purely for administrative reasons (e.g., to finish authentication of diplomas/transcripts)
- To formally move into employment, the standard work-authorization route applies: a Romanian employer must first obtain a work authorization for the graduate from the IGI, after which the graduate applies for a residence permit on work grounds

Note: according to some legal sources, the student-purpose residence permit itself is not directly convertible into a long-term residence permit – the change of purpose (study → work) is treated as a new residence permit application based on employment, even though it can build on the post-graduation extension period

10. Official Government Websites

- General Inspectorate for Immigration (IGI) – residence permits, studies, work permits: <https://igi.mai.gov.ro/en/>
- IGI – Studies page (primary source for this guide): <https://igi.mai.gov.ro/en/studies/>
- e-Viza portal (visa applications and appointments): <https://evisa.mae.ro>
- Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MAE): <https://www.mae.ro>
- IGI online residence permit portal: <https://portaligi.mai.gov.ro/portaligi/>
- EU Immigration Portal – Romania (EU Commission overview, in English): https://home-affairs.ec.europa.eu/policies/migration-and-asylum/eu-immigration-portal_en

11. Where to Download Official Forms

The IGI publishes residence permit forms directly on its studies page (<https://igi.mai.gov.ro/en/studies/>), including:

- Application for extension of temporary right of residence for study purposes
- Certificate to be issued by the educational institution
- Proof of means of subsistence template
- Proof of legal right to dwelling space template
- Medical certificate template
- Fee schedule document

A full list of all IGI forms (all purposes, not just studies) is available at:

<https://igi.mai.gov.ro/en/category/forms/>

Correct information: That page does not contain a full list of all IGI forms. It only lists a handful of general administrative forms (petition form, audience form, press accreditation form, public-information request forms). Forms for residence permits, asylum, and other purposes are published separately, on the relevant subject pages (e.g., the Studies page above, or igi.mai.gov.ro/en/forms/ for asylum-related forms). (Source: General Inspectorate for Immigration, igi.mai.gov.ro)

The D/SD visa application form itself is completed directly on the e-Viza portal (<https://evisa.mae.ro>); some embassy websites also offer a downloadable version of the same form.

12. Common Mistakes Students Make — and How to Avoid Them

- Skipping the Ministry of Education acceptance letter. A university admission/offer letter is not the same as the official Ministry of Education letter of acceptance required for the visa. Make sure this separate document is issued before applying.
- Applying too late. Given the 60-day legal maximum for a visa decision (and the recommended 45-day minimum lead time), late applications risk missing the start of term.
- Missing the residence permit deadline. Many students focus on the visa and forget that the residence permit must be filed within 90 days of arrival and at least 30 days before the visa-based stay expires.
- Incomplete or inconsistent financial proof. The amount must meet the current minimum gross salary threshold for the entire period on the visa/permit – partial or outdated bank statements are a common cause of delay or rejection.
- Not budgeting for tuition payment timing. Visa approval typically requires proof that at least one year's tuition has already been paid, not just an offer of admission.
- Letting accommodation paperwork lapse. Proof of legal right to housing is required again at each residence permit renewal; informal arrangements without a proper rental contract can cause problems.
- Exceeding the part-time work limit. Working beyond the permitted hours on a study-purpose residence permit (and without a separate work authorization) can jeopardize the resident's legal status.
- Forgetting the 30-day renewal window. Renewing late, or after the permit has already expired, creates legal and administrative complications.

- Assuming the study residence permit converts automatically into a work permit. Students wishing to stay and work after graduation need to actively pursue the employer-sponsored work authorization process within the post-graduation extension window, rather than assuming continuity is automatic.

A general note on accuracy: Romanian immigration rules (fee amounts, exact working-hour limits, minimum salary figures) are updated periodically. Some figures found on university and legal-service websites (e.g. the 4-hour vs. 6-hour work limit) differ depending on when the page was last updated. Before finalizing any application, confirm current figures directly on the IGI (igi.mai.gov.ro) and MAE (mae.ro/evisa.mae.ro) websites, or with the relevant Romanian embassy/consulate.